provided with a loan guarantee of £270 million to secure its Vauxhall operations in the UK.

The British government appeared to be prejudiced against the Indian group. It was so blatant that it made even the soft-spoken Ratan comment uncharacteristically about Mandelson's role and the befuddlement the stance caused in him, in an interview with *The Times* (London) on 10 March 2011.

First Signs of Recovery

Having secured financial assistance, Ratan got to work. As Jaguar and Land Rover did not have a 'cash management system of its own', in 2009, Tata Motors requisitioned the services of the 'Munich-based Roland Berger Strategy Consultants' to keep a watch on costs. Their remit was to make JLR profitable.

While the consultants worked out a strategy, Ratan adopted a five-pronged approach to revive the fortunes of the companies. These were: increasing sales, cutting costs, securing finance, updating and developing newer models, and strengthening the top management.

Sales could only be increased by looking beyond traditional markets. China and Russia, with their new millionaires, became a focus area. To save costs, Ratan looked at sourcing material and components from countries such as China and India. But he took pains to keep the brand identity untouched. Updated versions of 2010 models of the Land Rover and the Jaguar—the Range Rover Sport and Discovery 4, and the Jaguar models XF and XK—were launched to 'critical acclaim'.

The fifth dimension involved the revamping of Tata Motors' top management to particularly strengthen and expand JLR's international operations. Ratan underlined the need for the 'internationalisation' of the top management 'in order to truly compete in the global marketplace'. With this objective, he carefully chose and appointed two veterans to lead the change of focus in marketing.

The first was Carl-Peter Forster, former president of General Motors Europe. The second was Dr Ralf Speth, who was 'one of the main forces for the transformation of BMW in terms of design technology and quality'. Both were assigned to the team that was in charge of turning around the Land Rover's fortunes. They joined the group in February 2010, Forster as